greatest followings and long historical presence throughout the Indian subcontinent.[81]

Given the migration of the order's *pir*, Mu'in al-Din Sijzi Chishti (AH 536–633/1142–1236 CE), to northern India probably by the 1180s, when the Ghazna Shansabanis took Lahore (see Chapter 5), it is unlikely that the monumental remains of the Chisht complex housed the Sufi order; their *khanaqah* would have been housed by another, probably more humble structure.[82] Moreover, the complex's at least partial Hanafi affiliation – as argued above – would further make a link with the Chishtiyya or other Sufis precarious. Although spiritual teachings definable as mystical or "Sufi" encompassed enormous variety, in general it can be said that they were of a very different order than theological–juridical doctrines. Being much more personal, performative, and "ascetic–mystical"[83] as spiritual paths, Sufi teachings could not uniformly be associated with any of the orthodox *madhhab*s, and in fact could have gravitated toward Shi'ism and particularly its Isma'ili expression.[84]

The decidedly independent or *un*orthodox expressions of Islam associated with Sufism overall made it all the more likely to appeal to non-urban populations (not unlike Karrami teachings). Nevertheless, Bulliet noted that, certainly in eastern Khurasan, "mysticism was almost non-existent among the Hanafis … and most directly associated with the Shafi'i party" at least through the early twelfth century.[85] While the evidentiary *lacunae* make all observations conjectural, this brief digression on the Sufism burgeoning in Afghanistan during the twelfth–thirteenth centuries supports the idea that at Chisht also, where the Shansabanis were epigraphically acknowledged, *madhhab*s and spiritual movements other than the Karramiyya could have benefited – probably *via* indirect avenues – from the Shansabanis' political presence and perhaps even patronage.

The Minar *of Jam-Firuzkuh*

The preceding observations regarding the multiplicity of *madhhab*s in areas ostensibly within the Firuzkuh Shansabanis' purview in no way refute the Karrami affiliation of the *minar* at Jam-Firuzkuh (Figure 4.18). If anything, the foregoing scenario lends additional support for the *minar*'s interpretation as a monumental vehicle for Karrami expression, at the very heart of the Firuzkuh Shansabanis' *sard-sir* "capital." However, the *minar*'s epigraphic program was arguably the Karramiya's swan song, serving as an indication of their curtailed sphere of influence – increasingly focused on the Shansabanis' royal summer encampment and the local population – and their last response to these straitened circumstances before the Firuzkuh Shansabanis *officially* espoused the Shafi'iyya in AH 595/1199 CE.

Sourdel-Thomine's[86] definitive re-dating of the Jam-Firuzkuh *minar* from AH 590/1193–1194 CE to AH 570/1174–1175 CE certainly divests it of